REGULATIONS FOR THE DEGREE OF MASTER OF ECONOMICS (MEcon)

These Regulations apply to candidates admitted to the Master of Economics curriculum in the academic year 2026-27 and thereafter.

(See also General Regulations and Regulations for Taught Postgraduate Curricula)

Any publication based on work approved for a higher degree should contain a reference to the effect that the work was submitted to The University of Hong Kong for the award of the degree.

The degree of Master of Economics is a postgraduate degree awarded for the satisfactory completion of a prescribed course of study in economics with emphasis on the analysis of real world economic problems.

Admission requirements

ME 1. To be eligible for admission to the courses leading to the degree of Master of Economics, candidates shall

(a) comply with the General Regulations;
(b) comply with the Regulations for Taught Postgraduate Curricula;
(c) hold
  (i) a Bachelor's degree with honours of this University; *or*
  (ii) another qualification of equivalent standard from this University or from another University or comparable institution accepted for this purpose; and
(d) satisfy the examiners in a qualifying examination, if required.

Qualifying examination

ME 2.

(a) A qualifying examination may be set to test the candidates' formal academic ability or their ability to follow the courses of study prescribed. It shall consist of one or more written papers or their equivalent, and may include a project report.
(b) Candidates who are required to satisfy the examiners in a qualifying examination shall not be permitted to register until they have satisfied the examiners in the examination.

Award of degree

ME 3. To be eligible for the award of the degree of Master of Economics, candidates shall

(a) comply with the General Regulations;
(b) comply with the Regulations for Taught Postgraduate Curricula; and
(c) complete the curriculum and satisfy the examiners in accordance with the regulations set out below.

Advanced standing

ME 4. Advanced standing of up to two required courses, except the capstone course, may be granted if

(a) the course is completed at a graduate, postgraduate or master level from a recognized curriculum elsewhere within the last four years before admission to the Master of Economics curriculum for which a satisfactory grade has been obtained; or

(b) the candidate possesses a relevant professional qualification which was obtained before admission to the Master of Economics curriculum.

Period of study

ME 5. The curriculum shall normally extend over two academic years of full-time study. Candidates shall not be permitted to extend their studies beyond the maximum period of registration of three academic years, unless otherwise permitted or required by the Board of the Faculty. A period of study of not fewer than one academic year shall be granted if the candidate has fulfilled all the requirements for the award of the degree.

Completion of curriculum

ME 6. To complete the curriculum, candidates shall

(a) satisfy the requirements prescribed in TPG 6 of the Regulations for Taught Postgraduate Curricula;

(b) follow the courses of instruction and complete satisfactorily all prescribed written work and field work;

(c) satisfy the examiners in all prescribed courses as specified in the syllabuses and in any prescribed form of examination;

(d) if appropriate, complete and present a satisfactory project paper in lieu of one written paper in the examination, or complete and present a satisfactory research thesis in lieu of two papers in the examination, if such options are provided; and

(e) have achieved a cumulative GPA of 2.0 or above.

Title of research thesis

ME 7. Subject to the provisions of Regulation ME 6(d), candidates of the Advanced Research Stream shall submit the titles and proposals of their research thesis for approval by the supervisors before January first of the final academic year, and the research thesis shall be presented before August thirty-first of the final academic year. Candidates shall submit a statement that the research thesis represents their own work undertaken after registration in the course.

Assessment

ME 8. Candidates shall satisfy the examiners in all the prescribed courses as specified in the syllabuses. Examinations shall normally be held at the end of each course, unless otherwise specified. Only passed courses will earn credits.

ME 9. Candidates who have failed a course shall be required to sit for re-examination or to retake the course. If the failure is an elective course, candidates may elect to take another course as a substitute.

ME 10. Subject to the provisions of Regulation ME 6(d), candidates who have failed to present a satisfactory project paper or research thesis may be permitted to submit a new or revised project paper or research thesis within a specified period.

ME 11. Candidates who are unable, because of illness, to be present at the written examination of any course may apply for permission to present themselves at a supplementary examination of the same course to be held before the beginning of the following academic year. Any such applications shall be made on the form prescribed within two weeks of the first day of the candidates' absence from the examination.

ME 12. Candidates shall not be permitted to repeat a course for which they have received a passing grade for the purpose of upgrading.

ME 13. Candidates who have failed a total of more than two examinations/assessments or re-examinations/re-assessments during the entire period of study of the curriculum or who are not permitted to submit a new or revised research thesis shall be recommended for discontinuation under the provisions of General Regulations G12.

ME 14. There shall be no appeal against the results of examinations and all other forms of assessment.

Grading system

ME 15. Courses shall be graded according to the following grading system:

Grade	*Standard*	*Grade Point*
A+	Excellent	4.3
A		4.0
A-		3.7
B+	Good	3.3
B		3.0
B-		2.7
C+	Satisfactory	2.3
C		2.0
C-		1.7
D+	Pass	1.3
D		1.0
F	Fail	0

Assessment results

ME 16. On successful completion of the curriculum, candidates who have shown exceptional merit at the completion of the curriculum may be awarded a mark of distinction, and this mark shall be recorded in the candidates' degree diploma.

SYLLABUSES FOR THE DEGREE OF MASTER OF ECONOMICS (MEcon)

These syllabuses apply to candidates admitted to the Master of Economics in the academic year 2026-27 and thereafter.

CURRICULUM STRUCTURE

Candidates must take a total of ten 6-credit, or eight 6-credit and one 12-credit courses, including the completion of three core courses (on microeconomics, macroeconomics and econometrics) and a capstone course. They shall concentrate in one of the streams: Advanced Research Stream, Data Analysis Stream, Policy Analysis Stream and Theory Stream.

A list of electives will be announced at the beginning of the academic year. Up to two elective courses may be chosen from other taught postgraduate curricula offered by the Faculty of Business and Economics under the advice and approval of the Programme Directors concerned.

MEcon students can choose to take an Interdisciplinary Track from other specialized master's programmes offered by the Faculty of Business and Economics. They are required to complete a total of 30 credits for the Interdisciplinary Track, 12 credits for core and 18 credits for electives specified by the Interdisciplinary Track with each course carries 6 credits. Students who choose to take an Interdisciplinary Track will therefore need to complete a total of 15 courses, 10 for the MEcon programme and 5 for the chosen Interdisciplinary Track.

I. Fundamental Core Courses (Choose all) (6 credits each)

<u>Advanced Research Stream/ Theory Stream</u>

1. ECON6011 Microeconomic Theory/ ECON6092 Advanced Microeconomics*
2. ECON6012 Macroeconomic Theory/ ECON6093 Advanced Macroeconomics*
3. ECON6001 Applied Econometrics/ ECON6005 Econometric Theory I/ ECON6113 Advanced Econometrics*

*Students who have taken or are taking ECON6011 are not allowed to take ECON6092;
Students who have taken or are taking ECON6012 are not allowed to take ECON6093;
Students who have taken or are taking ECON6005 are not allowed to take ECON6001 or ECON6113;
Students who have taken or are taking ECON6113 are not allowed to take ECON6001

<u>Data Analysis Stream/ Policy Analysis Stream</u>

1. ECON6021 Microeconomic Analysis/ ECON6011 Microeconomic Theory (for candidates with strong undergraduate training in economics and mathematics)*
2. ECON6022 Macroeconomic Analysis/ ECON6012 Macroeconomic Theory (for candidates with strong undergraduate training in economics and mathematics)*
3. ECON6001 Applied Econometrics/ ECON6005 Econometric Theory I/ ECON6113 Advanced Econometrics*

*Students who have taken or are taking ECON6011 are not allowed to take ECON6021;
Students who have taken or are taking ECON6012 are not allowed to take ECON6022;
Students who have taken or are taking ECON6005 are not allowed to take ECON6001 or ECON6113;
Students who have taken or are taking ECON6113 are not allowed to take ECON6001

II. Stream Core Courses (6 credits each)

<u>Advanced Research Stream/ Theory Stream (Choose Three)</u>

- ECON6002 Selected Topics in Microeconomics I
- ECON6010 Monetary Policy: Theory and Practice

- ECON6036 Game Theory and Applications
- ECON6052 Selected Topics in Macroeconomics I
- ECON6056 Econometric Theory II
- ECON6059 Selected Topics in Macroeconomics II
- ECON6077 Topics in Economic Research I*
- ECON6078 Topics in Economic Research II*
- ECON6081 Quantitative Macroeconomics: Data, Model and Policy
- ECON6098 Advanced Topics in Labor Economics
- ECON6110 Labour Economics II
- ECON6120 Game Theory and Artificial Intelligence

Data Analysis Stream (Choose Three)

- ECON6067 Quantitative Tools for Economic Analysis: From Math to AI
- ECON6074 Causal Inference
- ECON6082 Data Visualization
- ECON6083 Applied Machine Learning
- ECON6086 Digital Economy and Big Data Analysis
- ECON6087 Textual Analysis for Economists
- ECON6106 Data-Driven Decision Making in Business
- ECON6111 Large Language Models: Theory and Practice

Policy Analysis Stream (Choose Three)

- ECON6008 International Macroeconomics and Finance
- ECON6032 International Trade and Multinationals
- ECON6034 Competition, Regulation and Business Strategy
- ECON6075 Economic Policy I
- ECON6076 Economic Policy II
- ECON6095 Programme Evaluation for Policy Makers
- ECON6097 Economic Growth and Development
- ECON6104 Introduction to Housing Markets
- ECON6105 Economics of AI and Innovation
- ECON6114 Economic Policy III
- ECON6120 Game Theory and Artificial Intelligence

* It can also be used to satisfy the Capstone requirement under Item III for candidates in the Theory Stream.

III. Capstone Courses

Advanced Research Stream

- ECON6080 Research Thesis (12 credits)

Data Analysis Stream (Choose One)

- ECON6116 Advanced Topics in Applied Economics: Data and Policy (6 credits)
- PMSC7901 Business Case Analysis Capstone (6 credits)
- PMSC7902 Business Case Analysis Capstone (Global Centres) (6 credits)

Policy Analysis Stream (Choose One)

- ECON6116 Advanced Topics in Applied Economics: Data and Policy (6 credits)
- PMSC7901 Business Case Analysis Capstone (6 credits)
- PMSC7902 Business Case Analysis Capstone (Global Centres) (6 credits)

Theory Stream (Choose One)

- ECON6077 Topics in Economic Research I (6 credits)
- ECON6078 Topics in Economic Research II (6 credits)
- PMSC7901 Business Case Analysis Capstone (6 credits)

- PMSC7902 Business Case Analysis Capstone (Global Centres) (6 credits)

IV. Electives

Candidates can choose electives from a list of courses to make the total number of credits taken sixty. Core courses can be taken as electives to fulfil the graduation requirements provided that they are not counted as core courses.

DESCRIPTION OF COURSES

ECON6001 Applied Econometrics (6 credits)
This course examines how practical problems can be solved by using econometric methods. The emphasis is on the analysis of real world economic data using advanced statistical software. Topics include: estimation and testing of linear regression models, regression diagnostics, robust estimation, bootstrap, panel data, nonlinear least squares, discrete choice models and forecasting methods.
Note: This course is not open to candidates who have taken or are taking ECON6005 or ECON6113.

ECON6002 Selected Topics in Microeconomics I (6 credits)
This is a special course that deals with various topics of microeconomics. Topics covered may vary from year to year, depending on the research interests of the instructor.

ECON6011 Microeconomic Theory (6 credits)
This course covers how consumers and producers make choices and how these choices are equilibrated by the market. In the part on choice theory, utility maximization and profit maximization problems together with corresponding dual problems are considered. Optimal value functions are studied and used to perform comparative static analysis. Restrictions imposed by optimization on consumer and producer behaviour are discussed. Choices under uncertainty are also investigated. The second part mainly covers the equilibrium in perfectly competitive markets and the two fundamental welfare theorems. It will also discuss the consequences of market failures, including public goods, externalities, and market power. Game theory will also be introduced.

ECON6012 Macroeconomic Theory (6 credits)
This course covers neo-classical macroeconomics, the Keynesian model and its problems, the consumption function and investment and economic fluctuations, supply and demand of money, the counter-revolution in monetary theory, inflation and unemployment and alternative policies for dealing with them, and open economy macroeconomics.

ECON6021 Microeconomic Analysis (6 credits)
This course provides an advanced treatment of standard tools and frameworks in microeconomics that are used in other courses of the curriculum. Topics include: constrained and unconstrained optimization, consumer theory, uncertainty and information, cost and production, and market structure and equilibrium.
Note: This course is not open to candidates who have taken or are taking ECON6011.

ECON6022 Macroeconomic Analysis (6 credits)
This course is an advanced treatment of the theory of the determination of national income and aggregate economic behaviour. Topics include: national income accounting, employment theory, inflation and deflation, monetary and fiscal policy for economic stabilization, economic growth, and international economic issues. Applications to contemporary economic issues are emphasized.
Note: This course is not open to candidates who have taken or are taking ECON6012.

ECON6005 Econometric Theory I (6 credits)
This course is an introduction to econometric theory and applications at an advanced level. Candidates are expected to be proficient in calculus, matrix algebra, and econometrics at the undergraduate level. Potential topics to be discussed include the classical linear model, generalized method of moments, and multiple equation models.
Note: Candidates may be required to pass a mathematics test in order to take the course.

ECON6006 Economics of Organization and Strategy (6 credits)
The organization component of this course discusses different theories of the firm, including the property rights approach and the incomplete contracting model. It forms the basic framework that is used to understand how various decisions are made within a firm. The incomplete contracting model can be further extended to study financial decisions such as capital structure, bankruptcy, and corporate voting. The strategy component uses game theory to understand how firms formulate strategies to cope with different competitive forces. Cases are used to illustrate how these strategies work. Examples include the meet-the-competition and most-favored-customer contractual clauses.
Note: This course is not open to candidates who have taken or are taking PMGM7019.

ECON6007 Industrial Organization (6 credits)
This course covers alternative forms of economic organizations, including the contractual nature of the firm, the meaning of monopoly and patent rights, the extraction of consumer surplus, and the purpose of integration and franchise arrangements. Government regulations will be discussed whenever appropriate.

ECON6008 International Macroeconomics and Finance (6 credits)
This course examines how openness in the form of commodity trade and factor (especially capital) mobility affects long-run growth and short-run fluctuations, as well as the effects of macroeconomic policies, across countries. Topics include: international income convergence; international business cycles; international policy coordination; exchange rate and balance of payments dynamics; currency and other financial crises; and puzzles in international financial markets.

ECON6009 Labour Economics (6 credits)
This course examines the operation of labour markets. The analytical approach is largely based on microeconomic theory. Attention is also given to issues involved in drawing inference from labour market data. Topics include: the theory and estimation of labour demand and supply, the selection problem, the structure of wages, the choice of labour contracts, investment in human capital, immigration and emigration, worker turnover and labour market frictions, labour market discrimination, and unemployment.

ECON6010 Monetary Policy: Theory and Practice (6 credits)
This course traces the evolution of central banks over the last 200 years from primitive financial clearing-houses to promoters of macroeconomic stability and growth as a natural progression as policy-makers sought to combat various challenges to macroeconomic stability, such as inflation and systemic financial risk. The course will discuss different monetary policy regimes, including currency boards and inflation targeting, and the inherent trade-offs between them, focusing especially on the importance of credibility and expectations. Optimal monetary policy design and the monetary transmission mechanism will also be covered.

ECON6014 Trade, Investment and Development in East Asia (6 credits)
This course examines various current topics and economic development problems facing East Asian economies. This course is mainly empirical. The economies we consider include China, Hong Kong, Taiwan, South Korea, Japan, Singapore and selective members of the ASEAN. The topics to be covered

will vary and be updated from year to year. Some of the main current economic issues include the competitiveness of East Asian economies, proposals for free trade areas, foreign direct investment and the economic strategy of multinational corporations, sources of past and future economic growth in East Asia, industry structure, technology policies, the Asian financial crisis, banking problems and exchange rate regimes.

ECON6015 Public Economics (6 credits)
This course covers the positive and normative analyses of the public sector in relation to efficiency and equity. It provides a better understanding of the making of public policy under asymmetric information and limited commitment, and the role of incentives in public administration. Topics include: market failure, welfare criteria, public goods and externalities, social choice and voting, income distribution, public pricing and investment, cost-benefit analysis and project appraisal, and the regulation of public enterprises.

ECON6031 The Chinese Economy (6 credits)
This course reviews the economic transformation of the People's Republic of China and its implications. China's experiences are subjected to theoretical and empirical analysis by using modern economic methods. The course covers structural and institutional changes as well as current debates on reform and policy. Topics include: history, geography, population, rural reform, industrialization, urbanization, enterprise reform, foreign trade and investment, financial system, and regional development.

ECON6032 International Trade and Multinationals (6 credits)
This course deals with the important issues of globalization focusing on international trade and multinationals. It includes both the traditional and contemporary theories. Topics include pattern of trade, comparative advantage, gains from trade, trade policy, factor mobility, bilateral and multilateral trade agreements, offshoring and decisions of multinationals. Each topic covers both theoretical and empirical analyses.

ECON6033 Corporate Finance (6 credits)
This course focuses on financial decisions in the modern corporation. Topics include: capital budgeting, cost of capital, capital structure, dividend policy, public offerings, and incentives and contacting problems. There will also be some treatment of mergers and acquisitions, and corporate governance. The objective of the course is to integrate these various topics into standard theories of risk and return and the valuation of assets in order to provide a theoretical framework for considering corporate finance problems and issues, with an understanding of how it applies to the real world.

ECON6034 Competition, Regulation and Business Strategy (6 credits)
Governments regulate markets to varying degrees. This course studies the economics of competition, monopolies and cartels, theories of regulation, regulation and taxation, and rent-seeking behaviour. These concepts are used to understand how business strategy in regulated markets differs from that in competitive markets. Selected case materials based on contemporary local examples from banking, container terminals, electricity and gas, transportation, telecommunications, air services, housing and property, and the gaming industry will also be used in classroom discussions.

ECON6035 Political Economy of Economic Policy (6 credits)
This course studies the relationship between the state and the market economy, especially highlighting the costs and benefits of economic policy interventions. Topics include: the economic value of the rule of law, property rights and institutional change, promoting competition and regulating markets, rules versus discretion in monetary, fiscal and exchange rate policy, and regionalism versus federalism. Selected case materials based on historical and contemporary examples will be used in classroom discussions, including international examples with emphasis on Hong Kong, China and Asia.

ECON6036 Game Theory and Applications (6 credits)
This course covers game theory and its applications to various fields of economics. It studies static games with complete information, dynamic games with complete information, static games with incomplete information, dynamic games with incomplete information, and the equilibrium concepts corresponding to these games. It considers applications of these concepts to the study of industrial organization, international trade, labour economics, public economics, corporate finance, and monetary economics. Applications to auction and bargaining are also considered. Finally, it offers an introduction to mechanism design and its application to the procurement problem.

ECON6037 Economic Forecasting (6 credits)
This course introduces basic techniques of forecasting, based on economic and structural time series models. ARIMA and regression models with trend, season, and cycle components will be considered. The hands-on experience in applying the techniques to real-world problems is emphasized. Topics include: basics of linear regression, modeling and forecasting trend and seasonality, basics of ARIMA models, forecasting cycles, forecasting with regression models, evaluating and combining forecasts, unit roots, stochastic trends, ARIMA models, and volatility models.

ECON6038 Health Economics (6 credits)
This course provides an overview of how economics play a role in the health care sector. Emphasis will be placed on contrasting the viewpoints of free-market economists and public health practitioners. Among the topics we discuss are the unique features of health in economic modeling, the demand for health and health care, equity and efficiency issues, forms of health care financing, an overview of cost-effectiveness and cost-benefit analysis, and National Health Accounting. Examples are drawn from local and international contexts.

ECON6039 Project Evaluation (6 credits)
This course covers the economic evaluation of projects from a public sector viewpoint using microeconomic tools. It explores the normative aspects of evaluating public projects and policies, the measurement of welfare change and public investment criteria. The concept of opportunity cost and benefit will be examined. Economic evaluation of government projects and Build-Operate-Transfer infrastructure projects will be discussed.

ECON6040 Transportation Economics (6 credits)
This course covers the theory and practice of modern transport economics using microeconomic tools. It views the buyer of transport services – be it passenger or freight – as playing a dual consuming and producing role. Topics include widgets versus transport, transport costs (internal and external), travel demand and the value of travel time, regulation and competition, and the cost-benefit analysis of transport projects. Contemporary issues in transport will also be analyzed from a transport economics methodological and welfare economics approach.

ECON6041 Alternative Approaches to Economic Analysis (6 credits)
In this course, we introduce and examine the principal ideas held by radical thinkers such as Marx, Velben, Commons, Robinson, and Sen in their critiques of capitalism and of neoclassical economics. The discourse is organized in the following topics: endogeneity of preferences, theories of wants and needs, theories of justice and fairness, macroeconomic instability of capitalism, socialism as an alternative to capitalism, and nationalism versus internationalism. The course emphasizes the use of modern analytic tools and will make use of, in particular, the recent progress in behavioural economics.

ECON6042 Mathematical Economics (6 credits)
This course presents both static and dynamic general equilibrium based on optimization to study

interrelated macroeconomic issues. In particular, Pontryagin optimal control theory and Bellman certainty and stochastic dynamic programming models will be covered. Such control theory and recursive multi-stage optimization methodology will be applied to important macro topics such as economic growth and employment.

ECON6052 Selected Topics in Macroeconomics I (6 credits)
This is a special course that deals with various topics of macroeconomics. Topics covered may vary from year to year, depending on the research interests of the instructor.

ECON6053 Selected Topics in Financial Economics (6 credits)
This is a special course that deals with various topics of financial economics. Topics covered may vary from year to year, depending on the research interests of the instructor.

ECON6055 Selected Topics in Investments and Asset Pricing (6 credits)
This course provides in-depth discussions on selected topics in investments, equilibrium and no arbitrage asset pricing theory. We will derive classic results on the mean-variance frontier, and asset pricing theory including the Capital Asset Pricing Model, Arbitrage Pricing Theory, Merton's continuous time model, the Black-Scholes option pricing models, and the Cox-Ingersoll-Ross term structure model. The objective of this course is to prepare candidates to read and appreciate research papers in academic journals and also provide a theoretical foundation to conduct advanced research in financial economics.

ECON6056 Econometric Theory II (6 credits)
This course is a continuation of Econometric Theory I (ECON6005). Potential topics to be discussed include panel data, maximum likelihood estimation, nonlinear regression models, time series models, and cointegration. The course will examine both the theoretical properties of these estimators and their implementation with professional statistical software.
Prerequisite: ECON6005

ECON6057 China in the Global Economy (6 credits)
This course will examine the progresses and challenges of China's rapid economic growth toward one of the largest economies in the world and its deepening integration into the global trade and financial systems. It will focus on China's interactions with the global economy and their domestic and international implications. The topics will include: Review of China's foreign trade and investment; reform, opening, growth and efficiency of China's domestic and external sectors and their impacts on the structure of China's balance of payments; China's currency and monetary policies and their impacts on the domestic and internal trade and finance; China's capital market reform and development and their domestic and international implications; China's role in maintaining international financial order.

ECON6058 Selected Topics in Microeconomics II (6 credits)
This is a special course that deals with various topics of microeconomics. Topics covered may vary from year to year, depending on the research interests of the instructor. However, topics covered in ECON6002 will not be covered in this course.

ECON6059 Selected Topics in Macroeconomics II (6 credits)
This is a special course that deals with various topics of macroeconomics. Topics covered may vary from year to year, depending on the research interests of the instructor. However, topics covered in ECON6052 will not be covered in this course.

ECON6060 Development Economics (6 credits)
This course covers topics pertinent to the development of low-income countries: economic growth, measurements of economic inequality, inequality and development and their inter-connections; poverty and under-nutrition, population growth and economic development, rural and urban, markets in agriculture, land, labour, credit and insurance, international trade, and trade policy. The course also teaches how to use data to conduct development analyses such as poverty assessments and impact analysis of development projects.

ECON6061 Network Economics (6 credits)
This course is divided into two parts. Part I of the course introduces graph theory and game theory. Graph theory is used to describe the structure of a network and game theory to understand how people behave in network with different structures. Part II of the course focuses on analysing network structures and understanding behaviour in different network structures.

ECON6062 Advanced Topics in Economic Forecasting (6 credits)
Building on student's previous background in Economic Forecasting, this course explores advanced topics in Economic Forecasting. These advanced topics may include forecasting when the relationship appears unstable, when we have a large number of candidate predictors, when real time data are available for updating our forecast, etc. We will also discuss the issues on forecasting various variables, such as output, inflation, the price of oil, real estate prices, interest rates, etc. While theory will be covered, our focus is in applications.
Prerequisite: ECON6037

ECON6063 Environmental Economics (6 credits)
This course develops a solid understanding of environmental economics. The course covers important environmental issues including overuse of the environment (such as overfishing and excessive air pollution emissions) and too little provision of environmental public goods (such as preservation of endangered species habitats and investment on biodiversity). This course is designed to cover an in-depth discussion of an economic approach to environmental problems in order to show how factors such as property rights and transaction-cost considerations can encourage efficient natural resource use through environmental markets. For environmentalists, this course also offers concrete solutions to illustrate the importance of environmental entrepreneurship.

ECON6064 Advanced Topics in Economic Analysis (6 credits)
This is a special course at the MEcon level that deals with various topics of microeconomics or macroeconomics, building on candidates' previous background in Microeconomic Analysis (ECON6021) and Macroeconomic Analysis (ECON6022). Topics covered may vary from year to year, depending on the research interests of the instructor. Candidates have the opportunities to apply their economic knowledge and research methodology in analyzing real-world problems (such as the economic impact of a specific business practice or government policy) in a theoretically and/or empirically rigorous manner.
Prerequisite: ECON6021 and ECON6022 or equivalent

ECON6065 Money and Banking (6 credits)
This is a course in money and banking at the masters or first-year graduate level. It discusses the role of money and the banking system in the economy and how they affect aggregate economic activity like inflation, interest rates and output growth. Topics include theories of money demand and supply, theories of interest rates, issues related to conduct of monetary policy, such as targets and indicators, rules versus discretion, time inconsistency, credit market imperfections, banking crisis, bank regulation, deposit insurance, among many others.

ECON6067 Quantitative Tools for Economic Analysis: From Math to AI (6 credits)
Part I of this course reviews the basic mathematical tools most widely used in economics. It is designed to prepare students for the microeconomics, macroeconomics, econometrics and other courses in the Programme. Part II - AI-Augmented Economic - introduces students to the practical use of AI coding agents for economic analysis. This part does not assume prior programming experience. Instead, it combines basic coding literacy with AI-assisted workflows, helping students learn how to set up a coding environment, understand and modify simple Python/R/Stata code, translate economic questions into executable analytical tasks, debug AI-generated code, and organize reproducible projects. Through hands-on exercises and mini projects, students will apply AI-augmented workflows to data cleaning, descriptive analysis, visualization, regression-based analysis, and short analytical reports, with an emphasis on human oversight, methodological rigor, and reproducibility.

ECON6068 Advanced Topics in Applied Econometrics (6 credits)
Building on student's previous background in Applied Econometrics (ECON6001), this course explores advanced topics in Applied Econometrics. Topics covered may vary from year to year, depending on the research interests of the instructor. While theory will be covered, our focus is on applications. Students have the opportunities to apply their knowledge in data analysis and economic concepts in analyzing real-world problems in an empirically rigorous manner.
Prerequisite: ECON6001 or equivalent

ECON6069 Advanced Topics in Economic Policy (6 credits)
This is a special course at the MEcon level that deals with various topics of economic policy. Topics covered may vary from year to year, depending on the research interests of the instructor. Students have the opportunities to apply their economic knowledge and research methodology in analyzing important economic policies, either historical or contemporary.
Prerequisite: ECON6021 and ECON6022 or equivalent

ECON6070 Applied Financial Econometrics (6 credits)
Financial econometrics is the intersection of statistical techniques and finance. Financial econometrics provides a set of tools that are useful for modeling financial data and testing beliefs about how markets work and prices are formed. Conversely, new techniques in analyzing financial data can lead to empirical facts inconsistent with existing theories, begging for new models or investment strategies. We focus on several empirical techniques which are often used in the analysis of financial markets and how they are applied to actual data.
Prerequisite: ECON6001 or equivalent

ECON6071 Urban Economics (6 credits)
In this course, we study how households and firms choose to agglomerate in confined urban areas and how the two choices interact to give rise to the spatial structure of economic activities. It examines the question of the where of economic activity, a question largely ignored in other branches of economics. Topics include the determination of the internal structure of cities, the sources and consequences of agglomeration economies, how cities may be too crowded or too sparsely populated, urban economic growth, urban labour market, urban transportation, and special topics, including but not restricted to urban crime and the future of cities.
Prerequisite: ECON6021 or equivalent

ECON6072 Economic Analysis of Aging Societies (6 credits)
The magnitude of demographic changes, including falling birth rates and rising life expectancy, has been substantial in many societies. Why do population changes of such magnitude arise, and how do they affect individual behaviour of households and firms, as well as the aggregate economy? This course examines these demographic changes, their consequences, and related policy issues. We first look at the time trend and cross-country differences in demographic variables such as mortality, fertility, immigration and age

structure. We then study economic consequences of demographic changes, including demographic dividend, saving and retirement decisions, human capital accumulation, and technological progress. Finally, we examine policy issues related to population aging, such as retirement pension and health care reform.
Prerequisite: ECON6021 and ECON6022 or equivalent

ECON6073 Mechanism Design (6 credits)
This course provides a systematic, comprehensive, and in-depth review of mechanism design and is divided into three parts. Part I of the course covers theory of mechanism design including the following topics: Mechanism Design Basics, Myerson's Lemma, Algorithmic Mechanism Design, Revenue-Maximizing Auctions, Simple Near-Optimal Auctions, and Multi-Parameter Mechanism Design. Part II of the course showcases applications of mechanism design with the following case studies: Spectrum Auctions, Mechanism Design with Payment Constraints, and Kidney Exchange and Stable Matching. In Part III of the course, students present their work on a research question and demonstrate their research ability in workshops.
Prerequisite: ECON6021 or equivalent

ECON6074 Causal Inference (6 credits)
This course introduces students to the challenges of interpreting observational data, and to different approaches designed to overcome these challenges. Drawing on examples from different areas in economics, the course provides an overview of research designs that aim at extracting credible causal relationships, such as difference-in-differences, matching estimators, instrumental variables, regression discontinuity, audit studies, natural experiments, and randomized control experiments. Students will be given hands-on experience with these research designs, and will learn their theoretical underpinning as well as their limitations.

ECON6075 Economic Policy I (6 credits)
This course will be taught by teacher(s) who have special expertise in different areas of economic policy. Emphasis is put on using economic analysis to shed light on the rationale behind specific economics policies and their implications for citizens and for business practices. The topics covered will vary depending on the expertise of the teaching staff; examples may include technology and the economy, income inequality, political economy of Hong Kong, political economy of China, trade policies in a globalized world, financial crises, land use policies, housing policy, competition policy, retirement protection, minimum wage, and health care policy.

ECON6076 Economic Policy II (6 credits)
This course will be taught by teacher(s) who have special expertise in different areas of economic policy. Emphasis is put on using economic analysis to shed light on the rationale behind specific economics policies and their implications for citizens and for business practices. The topics covered will vary depending on the expertise of the teaching staff; examples may include technology and the economy, income inequality, political economy of Hong Kong, political economy of China, trade policies in a globalized world, financial crises, land use policies, housing policy, competition policy, retirement protection, minimum wage, and health care policy. However, topics covered in ECON6075 will not be covered in this course.

ECON6077 Topics in Economic Research I (6 credits)
This course will be taught by teacher(s) who have special expertise in different fields in economics. Students are introduced to the basic set of questions addressed by each field of specialization covered, and the conceptual framework commonly adopted to address these questions. Emphasis is put on making sure that students are familiar with the literature in the relevant field, and are equipped with the tools to do their independent research. The fields covered will depend on the interests of students and the availability of teaching staff with expertise in the relevant fields. The fields of specialization covered may include labour

economics, public economics, political economy, economic growth and development, economic history, industrial organization, international trade, international macroeconomics, and urban economics.

ECON6078 Topics in Economic Research II (6 credits)
This course will be taught by teacher(s) who have special expertise in different fields in economics. Students are introduced to the basic set of questions addressed by each field of specialization covered, and the conceptual framework commonly adopted to address these questions. Emphasis is put on making sure that students are familiar with the literature in the relevant field, and are equipped with the tools to do their independent research. The fields covered will depend on the interests of students and the availability of teaching staff with expertise in the relevant fields. The fields of specialization covered may include labour economics, public economics, political economy, economic growth and development, economic history, industrial organization, international trade, international macroeconomics, and urban economics. However, topics covered in ECON6077 will not be covered in this course.

ECON6079 Behavioural Economics (6 credits)
The course introduces behavioural economics and tries to keep it in historical context. Behavioural economics and rational models of economics are considered to be complementary instead of competing. Rational models are covered in the course to provide us a solid background to appreciate the contributions of behavioural economics. Behavioural economics helps us better understand decision-making under certainty, judgment under risk and uncertainty, decision-making under risk and uncertainty, and intertemporal choice. Although rational models are not perfectly consistent with actual behaviour, they can be used to show how choice and decision can be improved.

ECON6080 Research Thesis (12 credits)
The course is designed for students who are admitted to the Advanced Research Stream. The Research Thesis shall consist of original work written under the supervision from one of the faculty members at the Faculty of Business and Economics. Students shall submit the titles and proposals of their research thesis for approval by the supervisors before January first of the final academic year, and the research thesis shall be presented before August thirty-first of the final academic year. The research thesis, which should not exceed 30,000 words in length, shall be graded by the supervisors and approved by the MEcon Board of Examiners. Assessment shall be conducted in the form of 100% coursework.

ECON6081 Quantitative Macroeconomics: Data, Model and Policy (6 credits)
This course will equip students with the numerical tools (data skills and computation skills) necessary to tackle interesting questions in quantitative macroeconomics. The course consists of three major parts: data, model, and policy. The first part focuses on showing students how to deal with macro and micro data in economics and more importantly, how to find interesting empirical patterns from the data. The second part is about the study of computational methods and algorithms useful to solving and analyzing macro models. The third part is devoted to ongoing frontier research in macroeconomics based on heterogeneous-agent models.

ECON6082 Data Visualization (6 credits)
This course will introduce students to the principles and techniques of data visualization. Students will learn the value of visualization, specific techniques to clear, manipulate, and visualize different types of data, and how to best leverage visualization. Through examples, in-class demonstration, student will master the procedures and programming skills to visualize six conventional types of data relationships: Relation, comparison, distribution, proportion, time series, and spatial, as well as the more advanced methods for interactive visualization and visualizing spatial raster, network, or high-dimensional data. Students will also learn how to harvest the advantages of the programming language of R to automate the process of data manipulation in batch.

ECON6083 Applied Machine Learning (6 credits)
This course is an in-depth introduction into modern Machine Learning (ML) learning techniques for economists. Unlike in some other disciplines where ML is used for prediction, in economics we typically interested in estimation of structural or causal relationships between variables. In this course, we will focus on two ML techniques, Lasso and Random Forests, that have been adapted for use in applied econometrics for the purpose of estimation and inference on structural and causal effects. We will discuss the need for ML methods in empirical work in economics, the statistical properties of the ML methods, and discuss their applications.

ECON6084 The Economics of Law (6 credits)
Economic analysis applied to law. Topics may include: efficiency of law, rules of liability, tort rights and remedies, criminal sanction, legislative processes as resource allocating and income distributing mechanisms.
Prerequisite: ECON6011 or ECON6021 or equivalent

ECON6085 Topics in Macroeconomic Research of China (6 credits)
The course will cover some selected research topics that are relevant for China such as growth, structural change, trade and migration, banking system and monetary policy, DSGE models with Chinese characteristics, etc. For each topic, there will be discussions of both the appropriate theoretical framework and methods and their applications to the Chinese economy.

ECON6086 Digital Economy and Big Data Analysis (6 credits)
This course introduces fundamental ideas, important methods and popular techniques in big data analysis and machine learning. Combining statistical theory, computational tools, and hands-on experience with real data, this course will provide students with a solid basis for handling big data in the practice of economics, finance, and management.

ECON6087 Textual Analysis for Economists (6 credits)
An ever-increasing share of human communication is recorded as digital text. This course introduces students to the quantitative analysis of text from a social science perspective, with a special focus on Economics and Finance. The course introduces the theoretical foundations for text analysis but mainly takes a practical approach, illustrating the methods for systematically extracting quantitative information from text, from classical content analysis and dictionary-based methods, to classification methods, scaling methods, and topic models. Lectures will be complemented with hands-on exercises working with text data in R.

ECON6088 Quantitative Finance: Introduction and Applications (6 credits)
This module introduces students to quantitative finance and will enable students to use mathematical tools to analyze and to tackle real-world financial issues and questions. Specific concepts to be covered include the time value of money, interests compounding, diversification, hedging, and pricing of bonds, stocks, forwards/futures, options, and other derivatives.

ECON6089 Modern Econometrics for Business Strategy (6 credits)
This course introduces the science and art of building and using econometric models in the analysis of business strategy. It aims to equip business and economics students to understand and appreciate econometric analysis in economic and business strategy analysis, and to provide students with an understanding of three widely used techniques in modern econometrics: randomized control trials, regression discontinuity, and differences-in-differences.

ECON6090 The Political Economy of Global Business (6 credits)
Globalization has expanded rapidly in recent decades, transforming how firms produce, invest, compete, and organize their supply chains. More recently, however, rising geopolitical tensions, economic nationalism, and national security concerns have placed international economic integration under increasing pressure. This course examines the political and economic forces shaping globalization and the global business environment. It introduces analytical frameworks for understanding international trade, foreign investment, global value chains, multinational production, exchange-rate movements, and international migration, while exploring how industrial policy, sanctions, export controls, and geopolitical rivalry affect international economic cooperation and business decisions.
Note: This course is not open to candidates who have taken or are taking PMGM7015 and MSMK7027.

ECON6091 Introduction to Digital Platform (6 credits)
This course provides an overview of and basic analytical tools for digital platforms. The focus is on the applications of economic theory to understand digital platforms. Topics include (1) Definitions and Typology of Platforms, (2) Ratings, Recommendations, and the Use of Big Data, (3) An Economic Primer on Network Goods, (4) Growing a Platform, (5) Platform Pricing, and (6) Platform Design. Novel regulation and competition policy issues specific to the digital economy will be introduced towards the end of the course.

ECON6092 Advanced Microeconomics (6 credits)
This course is designed to provide training in advanced microeconomic theory for first-year Master's students. The course will focus on decision theory, game theory, and mechanism design at a graduate level. The first part covers the theory of individual decision making. The second part covers game theory, which is concerned with analyzing strategic interactions among agents. The third part covers topics in mechanism design, which explores how to apply game-theoretic concepts studied insofar to design effective institutions.
Note: This course is not open to candidates who have taken or are taking ECON6011.

ECON6093 Advanced Macroeconomics (6 credits)
This course provides an in-depth study of advanced macroeconomic theory and its application to real-world issues. Students will learn to analyze macroeconomic problems from different perspectives and understand the tools and techniques used to address them. The emphasis will be on the microeconomic foundations and decisions that underlie the behavior of aggregate variables. Students will also learn to connect economic theories to data.
Note: This course is not open to candidates who have taken or are taking ECON6012.

ECON6094 Transnational and Shared History of China and World (6 credits)
This course focuses on modern history of China and the world from perspectives of transnational and shared experience. It will explain how China becomes China with especial focus on the following topics: 1. forced transformation from a civilization to a nation-state; 2. Wars and peace and China's struggles; 3. Chinese and Americans: a shared history; 4. Body, mind, and sports: Chinese shared experiences with the past and the world; 5. How "China" becomes today's China and how Chinese become Chinese. It is crucial for anyone to know this kind of history in today's world, and it seems more important if one wants to become a leader in business world. Without a deep understanding of the past, one cannot move ahead in the future.

ECON6095 Programme Evaluation for Policy Makers (6 credits)
This course is about the analysis of data within economics and the interpretation of empirical results. The course will provide a practical introduction to econometric techniques and analytical methods commonly used in modern empirical research, such as matching, difference-in-differences, instrumental variables or regression discontinuity designs.

ECON6096 Computational Methods in Economics (6 credits)
In modern economic research, computers enhance our capacity of solving complex problems. Computation is particularly important in fields involving massive data. The objective of this course is to introduce graduate students to computational approaches for solving economic models, with an emphasis on dynamic programming and simulation-based econometric methods. We will formulate economic problems in computationally tractable form and use techniques from numerical analysis to solve them. The substantive applications will cover a wide range of problems including labor, industrial organization, macroeconomics, and international trade.

ECON6097 Economic Growth and Development (6 credits)
This course will introduce some basic theory about economic growth and development and use the theoretical framework to quantitatively examine economic growth and development over time and across space. The topics covered will include basic facts about economic growth and development, growth accounting, development accounting, structural change, factor misallocation and aggregate productivity. Throughout the course, the growth and development of the Chinese economy will be used as an important case study.

ECON6098 Advanced Topics in Labor Economics (6 credits)
This course will prepare students to conduct own research in the field of labor economics as well as related areas such as personnel economics, public economics and family economics. In this course, we will cover a wide range of theoretical models and empirical studies based on cutting-edge classic and recent research papers. During the course, students will be encouraged to develop own research ideas.

ECON6099 Topics in Growth and Development (6 credits)
This course will cover some selected research topics that are relevant for China such as growth, structural change, trade and migration, banking system and monetary policy, DSGE models with Chinese characteristics, etc. For each topic, there will be discussions of both the appropriate theoretical framework and methods and their applications to the Chinese economy.

ECON6100 International Study Field Trip (6 credits)
This course is designed to provide students an opportunity to acquire first-hand knowledge of international business environment. Experiential learning and knowledge exchange will be applied throughout the study field trip to develop students' understanding of international business environment in a different cultural context and help them construct a global perspective. Firm visits and cultural related activities will be arranged during the study field trip to arouse students' awareness in cultural diversity and enhance their understanding of how culture can impact international business strategy.
Note: This course is not open to candidates who have taken or are taking MACC7025, MFIN7057, PMGM7016, MSBA7034 or MSMK7020.

ECON6101 Introduction to Nudging and A/B Testing (6 credits)
The goal of this course is to equip students with a practical skill of proposing nudging solutions to achieve desire outcomes in commercial and policy making contexts; and testing the effectiveness of these solutions by experimentation (aka A/B Testing). Nudging is a concept rooted in behavioral economics and choice architecture, which involves subtly influencing people's decisions or behavior without restricting their freedom of choice.

ECON6102 Artificial Intelligence in Financial Economics (6 credits)
This course is to introduce modern AI technology and its principles, and to provide real experience of applying AI technology to finance and economics problems. The course aims to help students understand how to apply AI techniques in quantitative finance analysis and risk management.

ECON6103 Serendipitous Forces (6 credits)
Accompanying the core professional skills at the heart of a leading executive's career, executives will face a range of "serendipitous" challenges for which they are rarely formally prepared. But these unpredictable external factors will likely play a significant – perhaps decisive – role in determining how effectively he or she navigates a successful career. This course specifically addresses these powerful "serendipitous" real world forces as an indispensable compliment, examining a diverse range of factors that shape the context in which all companies must navigate.
Note: This course is not open to candidates who have taken or are taking PMGM7036.

ECON6104 Introduction to Housing Markets (6 credits)
This course provides a comprehensive introduction to housing markets, utilizing a combination of theoretical and empirical approaches. It explores the key issues in housing markets and examines the diverse interventions implemented by governments to address these challenges. It not only offers numerous real-world case studies from various regions but also uses big data to enhance insights into the housing market analysis.

ECON6105 Economics of AI and Innovation (6 credits)
This course provides rigorous analysis of how the advances in artificial intelligence and digital technology transform the economy and society. It will not only cover conventional topics on the impact of AI on innovation, business strategy, firm dynamics, employment, and economic growth, but also guide students to explore frontier topics related to social media, digital entertainment, gig economy, and algorithmic regulation. The course will be grounded on economic analysis and empirical methods with an emphasis on applications instead of methodological sophistication. Students are expected to master basic analytic and empirical tools to study knowledge, innovation, and AI in economics and management. Students will be assessed based on problem-solving assignments and a business analytical project.
Note: This course is not open to candidates who have taken or are taking PMGM7040.

ECON6106 Data-Driven Decision Making in Business (6 credits)
This course aims to bridge the gap by training students how to apply economic theories, statistical methods, and quantitative tools students learnt in coursework to real world empirical context. Students will encounter cases such as how an e-commerce company determines their 3-year logistic infrastructure planning through structural demand models or how a social network app business iterates its product features through complicated experimental design. The materials will not only connect students with the real-world business, but also help students build a solid understanding of econometric /quantitative modeling in a practical manner.

ECON6107 Financial Economics and Investment (6 credits)
This course offers a rigorous and accessible introduction to financial economics and investment at a graduate level. Its aim is to provide students with the essential economic theory that forms the foundation for understanding finance and investment analysis, as well as a basic understanding of financial institutions, financial instruments, and asset markets. Moreover, it strives to bridge the gap between financial economic theory and its real-world application in the investment domain.

ECON6108 Professional Development Programme (6 credits)
The course aims to provide students with practical knowledge and workplace skillsets shared by practitioners from various commercial and industrial sectors for the professional development and career advancement of students. Trending topics and current issues will be covered to equip students with the mindset and calibre for the challenges they are going to come across at workplace. With an emphasis on practice, the course instructors will deliver in-depth lectures on real world business issues.

ECON6109 Independent Study Project (6 credits)
This course offers a valuable opportunity for students to take ownership of their learning and produce an original and substantive piece of work. It allows them to tailor their studies to their individual interests and career aspirations. Students will produce a report or research paper on a topic of their choice on a specific business issue, industry or problem that they are particularly interested in. It gives them the opportunity to apply the skills and knowledge gained throughout the master's programme in a self-directed study project under the supervision of a faculty advisor.

ECON6110 Labour Economics II (6 credits)
This course will prepare research students to conduct own research in the field of labour economics as well as related areas such as personnel economics, public economics and family economics. In this course, we will cover a wide range of theoretical models and empirical studies based on cutting-edge classic and recent research papers. During the course, students will be encouraged to develop own research ideas.

ECON6111 Large Language Models: Theory and Practice (6 credits)
This course explores the fundamentals and applications of Large Language Models (LLMs) in Natural Language Processing. Students will study the progression from traditional NLP to modern transformer architectures, mastering the theoretical foundations of attention mechanisms, tokenization, and model architectures. Through hands-on experience with state-of-the-art models, students will learn essential skills in prompt engineering, fine-tuning, and model deployment. The course combines practical implementation with critical discussions of ethical considerations, preparing students to develop and deploy LLM-based solutions while understanding their capabilities and limitations in real-world applications.

ECON6112 The Economics of Valuation (6 credits)
This course examines valuation techniques, integrating traditional financial models with advanced economic theories and practical applications, emphasizing the Chinese economy. Students will master discounted cash flow (DCF), relative valuation, and real options, applying these to specialized areas such as financial service firms, money-losing firms, start-ups, private firms, acquisitions, real estate, and distressed equity. Through theoretical instruction, practical exercises, and a group project, students will develop expertise in valuing diverse assets in complex markets. Microsoft Excel is used to illustrate the ideas of valuation.

ECON6113 Advanced Econometrics (6 credits)
This course is designed for advanced Master's students, focusing on cross-sectional techniques and the foundational methods of modern econometrics, such as least squares estimation, the maximum likelihood method, and the generalized method of moments. Students are expected to have a solid undergraduate-level understanding of calculus, matrix algebra, and probability theory.
Note: This course is not open to candidates who have taken or are taking ECON6005.

ECON6114 Economic Policy III (6 credits)
This course in economic policy is taught by specialists in their respective areas of expertise. This self-contained course has two parts: 1) Labour market policies, including anti-discrimination laws, unemployment insurance, minimum wage laws, and migration policies, and 2) Housing, land, and rates (property taxes) in Hong Kong.
Prerequisite: ECON6021

ECON6115 Emergency Room Macroeconomic Practices in the Last 50 Years (1973 – 2023) (6 credits)
The course instructor will use the case study method to teach macroeconomic principles to familarise the students with the application of these principles to practice. The case studies will be drawn from several large disruptive macroeconomic crises that occurred after 1970.

ECON6116 Advanced Topics in Applied Economics: Data and Policy (6 credits)
This advanced, capstone-level course provides an integrative experience that bridges economic theory, institutional analysis, and applied empirical research. Designed for MEcon students, it develops the skills necessary to analyze significant societal and policy-related challenges through a rigorous, seminar-based format. The course begins with a foundation in institutional economics and policy evaluation, before advancing to the practical application of econometric techniques. Students will engage with classic and contemporary literature to critically evaluate the choice and limitations of econometric models for specific research goals. This theoretical and methodological grounding prepares students to undertake independent research projects.

ECON6117 AI-Enabled Economic Policy Research (6 credits)
This is an intensive course built around a single team research project in economic policy. Students will form teams of three, identify a policy question relevant to Hong Kong or the broader region, assemble data, conduct empirical analysis, and produce a 10-page policy research paper. Structured lectures introduce the fundamentals of policy-oriented research: how policy questions differ from academic research questions, how to bring data to bear on policy decisions, and how to write for decision-makers rather than referees. Students are strongly encouraged to use AI tools (LLMs, AI coding assistants) at every stage.
Note: This course is not open to candidates who have taken or are taking PMGM7046.

ECON6118 Government and Regulation (6 credits)
We live in a world shaped by regulation: the air we breathe, the water we drink, the food we eat, the cars we drive, the homes we live in, and the schools we attend are all influenced by government oversight. But why do governments regulate? Do we have too much or too little regulation? And how does regulation impact economic development — does it foster growth or create barriers? This course aims to explore these questions while equipping students with analytical tools to evaluate them critically. The course is structured into two parts, which are (1) Theoretical Foundations of Government and Regulation, and (2) Applications in the Political Economy of Regulation. The second part will examine contentious topics such as industrial policy, data governance, and social mobility.

ECON6119 Political Economy of Development in China (6 credits)
This course examines the political and institutional foundations of China's economic development from the late imperial era to the present. Integrating insights from political economy, economic history, and applied econometrics, it explores how state capacity, ideology, and institutional design have shaped China's long-run development trajectory and its divergence — and later convergence — with the West.

ECON6120 Game Theory and Artificial Intelligence (6 credits)
This course studies how game theory can be used to analyse strategic interactions involving artificial intelligence agents. As AI systems become more capable and autonomous, economists, firms, regulators, and users will increasingly face situations in which one or more decision-makers are artificial agents rather than humans. These agents may bargain, compete, make recommendations, delegate tasks, respond to incentives, or interact with other AI systems. Understanding how to design, test, and manage such interactions requires adapting the tools of game theory to the distinctive features of artificial agents.

PMSC7001 Business Environment and Capital Markets (6 credits)
This course provides a comprehensive examination of China's business environment and the intricate capital markets. China's capital markets have undergone a remarkable transformation over the past few decades, transitioning from a closed system to one that is increasingly integrated with global financial markets. The first part of this course guides students to explore China's economic policy framework, analyzing the design, implementation, and outcomes of key policy initiatives that have shaped the business environment of the world's second-largest economy. The second part of this course leads students to study

the practical aspects of China's capital markets, including the stock and bond markets, the banking system, the investment with commodity and currency, the derivatives markets, and corporate governance issues in China. Students will gain valuable insights into the unique characteristics that shape China's financial markets, institutions, and regulatory frameworks. Students will engage in case studies, group discussions, and individual assignments to deepen their understanding of the complexities involved in navigating the Chinese financial system. The course aims to empower students to develop their own analytical frameworks for assessing financial opportunities and challenges in China, equipping them for successful careers.

PMSC7002 Artificial Intelligence: Implications for Business Strategy, Innovation and Entrepreneurship (6 credits)

This course introduces artificial intelligence from a managerial, organizational, and applied perspective, with particular emphasis on its implications for business strategy, innovation, and entrepreneurship. It helps students build a practical understanding of AI concepts, tools, capabilities, and limitations, and then moves to the application of AI across business functions, industries, startups, and enterprise settings. The course is organized into topics across six modules: AI foundations and literacy; AI tools, workflows, and product logic; functional and industry applications; AI strategy and business model innovation; work redesign, organization, and leadership; and AI ethics, governance, risk, and future careers. This course does not focus on the technical details or theoretical aspects of AI. Instead, this course places particular emphasis on how AI is reshaping competitive advantage, business models, innovation pathways, venture creation, work design, and the capabilities required of future founders, managers, and professionals. Rather than training students to build AI systems themselves, the course prepares them to identify AI-enabled opportunities, evaluate new venture ideas, understand how AI can be embedded into products and workflows, and participate in AI-driven business transformation in future professional settings.

PMSC7003 Global Business Environments Immersion: Institutions, Innovation, and Cross-Cultural Management (6 credits)

This course provides HKU Master's students with a comprehensive and academically grounded understanding of global business environments, with a particular focus on Europe as a complex institutional, regulatory, and innovation-driven context. Anchored in Barcelona, the course integrates institutional analysis with applied learning in multinational and cross-cultural settings. Experiential learning is central to the course design, with company visits (e.g., leading technology firms, multinational corporations, and international firms operating in Europe), practitioner-led sessions, and interactive workshops forming a core part of the learning experience.

PMSC7004 Building Successful AI-First Ventures: Spotlight on Product Management (6 credits)

This course prepares HKU Master's students to analyze, design, and develop AI-enabled ventures across startup and corporate contexts. It integrates strategic, analytical, and managerial frameworks with hands-on project work, enabling students to identify high-impact opportunities, design AI-native products, and construct evidence-based investment cases. Set within the broader transformation of business driven by artificial intelligence, the course emphasizes an "AI-first" approach to value creation, competitive strategy, and organizational innovation, with consideration of ethical and regulatory implications in global markets. Structured around key stages of the AI venture lifecycle — opportunity identification, product and system design, and investment readiness — the course combines conceptual learning with applied team projects, including no-code prototyping and venture development. Project scope is calibrated to ensure feasibility within the course duration. By the end of the course, students will have developed a functional prototype and a well-supported venture proposal.

PMSC7901 Business Case Analysis Capstone (6 credits)

This course aims at bridging academic learning with real-world applications, equipping students for their future careers through practical problem-solving. This course allows students to integrate and apply the knowledge and techniques that they have learned in previous courses in a business project. Teams of students will carry out business projects using real-world data and have the opportunity to be involved in different stages in a business project, including project planning and management, strategy setting, model

building, data analysis and interpretation, and result presentation. In the process, students will become familiar with the use of analytics tools and managerial skills in business projects. This course will provide a dynamic and student-centered experience that fosters real-world engagement and career readiness.
Note: This course is not open to candidates who have taken or are taking PMSC7902. The course code of this course has been changed from ECON7902 to PMSC7901, and this course is not open to candidates who have taken ECON7902.

PMSC7902 Business Case Analysis Capstone (Global Centres) (6 credits)
This course aims at bridging academic learning with real-world applications, equipping students for their future careers through practical problem-solving. Offered in conjunction with Study Modules at Global Centres, this capstone project allows students to integrate and apply the knowledge and techniques that they have learned in previous courses in a business project undertaken in a global context. Teams of students will carry out business projects using real-world data and have the opportunity to be involved in different stages in a business project, including project planning and management, strategy setting, model building, data analysis and interpretation, and result presentation. Projects are normally sourced from, or conducted in collaboration with, partner organisations at the respective Global Centres. In the process, students will become familiar with the use of analytics tools and managerial skills in business projects. This course will provide a dynamic and student-centered experience that fosters real-world engagement and career readiness.
Note: This course is not open to candidates who have taken or are taking PMSC7901.

ASSESSMENT
Candidates shall be assessed for each of the courses for which they have registered, and assessment is normally conducted in the form of coursework assessment (40-100%) and examinations (0-60%), unless otherwise specified by the course instructor.